

1947, October 4.

Dr. J. P. Young  
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Dear Doctor: You gave me a treatment on Tuesday. God bless you for it. I hope that I shall always appreciate such favors - every and all favors; for appreciation means gratitude and: "Gratitude for favors is unquestionably one of the very first and surest indications of intelligence." But I felt that day there was something on your mind; that you were not your own self - happy as you ought to be. In fact I've felt that way more or less right along. The next day I again had the great privilege of singing a High-Mass, and as usual for several months I had J.P. pretty much in my mind. During the "Pater Noster", possibly due to more than ordinary fervor, when I came to the words: "...sicut nos dimittimus..." - And forgive us .. as we forgive those who trespass against us", I almost faltered. There was something like an answer or a response in my very soul to the effect: "Unless and until he forgive .. I can not." That evening at Matins you came to my mind again as I intoned the psalm: "Nisi Dominus...", "Unless the Lord build the house, they labor in vain who build it." (126) And from the other choir came back the response like a divine sanction: "Unless the Lord keep the city, he watcheth in vain that keepeth it."

Now Doctor: I want to assure you that it is not to embarrass you that I am writing you thus. On the contrary, I positively feel that I could not be your friend without making as strong an effort as possible to save you fearful embarrassment unquestionably ahead of you unless, by the grace of God you open your eyes and cease trying to do without Him, - without God!

After all, what is the embarrassment of a friendly fraternal correction when contrasted with the multiplied accusation at the General Judgement Tomorrow before heaven and earth as well as all Hell? For my part I have long since come to the conclusion that when there is trouble ahead, the quicker we prepare to meet it the less its going to amount to; whereas, the less we make of it, if it be real, the worse its going to prove.